ADVANCED VRC03
Paragraph Summary, Theme Completion
Class Sheet

Time: 60 minutes

ALL questions in CLASS SHEET are to be discussed in the class; no solutions will be provided for the same. You may discuss the doubts etc. of the Home Sheet in the next session.

Directions for questions 1 to 22: From among the options, choose the summary of the passage that is written in the same style as that of the passage.

1. The mass extinction of languages is a process that can be resisted and mitigated, though surely not halted completely. The first imperatives are toleration and accommodation: the cessation of active persecution and a serious struggle against linguistic chauvinism and privilege everywhere, starting at home. Where the remaining indigenous languages look to be in terminal decline, as in the United States, Canada, or Australia, the question is how best to bolster the many new Native-led revitalization programs, as some state and provincial governments are starting to do.
   A] Languages are bound to get extinct and there is no possible way to stop it let alone avoid it.
   B] Extinction of languages has become unstoppable though avoidable, and the only way to replenish languages is to encourage the new Native-led revitalization programs as some state and provincial governments have begun to do.
   C] Extinction of languages is a global emergency and all the developing nations should start encouraging the Native-led revitalization programs instead of eradicating the indigenous languages.
   D] Indigenous languages are declining gradually in countries like United States, Canada, or Australia, and there exists a need for active participation from such countries in new Native-led revitalization program.

2. The photograph and the words arrive simultaneously. They guarantee each other. You believe the words more because the photograph verifies them, and trust the photograph because you trust the words. Additionally, each puts further pressure on the interpretation: A war photograph can, for example, make a grim situation palatable, just as a story about a scandal can make the politician depicted look pathetic. But images, unlike words, are often presumed to be unbiased. The facticity of a photograph can conceal the craftiness of its content and selection.
   A] Whatever assumptions a viewer uses as a filter to judge the accuracy of an image can also be used by the presenter to deceive.
   B] Viewers will believe in a photograph's truth as long as they believe it corresponds in a meaningful way to reality.
   C] While considering an image's truthfulness, a viewer will also apply assumptions regarding its categorization and place of appearance.
   D] Images have an enormous potential to convey information to us in such a way that we accept it as the truth without conscious critical analysis.

3. For decades, Americans believed that they had the world's healthiest and safest diet. They worried little about this diet's effect on the environment or on the lives of the animals (or even the workers) it relies upon. Nor did they worry about its ability to endure -- that is, its sustainability. That didn't mean all was well. And they've come to recognize that their diet is unhealthful and unsafe. Many

food production workers labor in difficult, even deplorable, conditions, and animals are produced as if they were widgets. It would be hard to devise a more wasteful, damaging, unsustainable system.

A] Food and everything surrounding it is a crucial matter of personal and public health, of national and global security.

B] Sustainable methods of producing meat for consumption exist.; at the same time, we must educate and encourage Americans to eat differently.

C] Formulation of a sustainable system is imperative to control the slaughter of animals for food purposes.

D] Everything labeled "healthy" and "natural" is not to be trusted.

4. Though nihilism and existentialism are distinct philosophies, they are often confused with one another. A primary cause of confusion is that Friedrich Nietzsche is a central philosopher in both fields. Adding to the confusion is a form of existentialism, nihilistic existentialism, which contains elements of both. What sets existential nihilists apart from pure nihilists is that while nihilists do not believe in any meaning whatsoever, existential nihilists only believe this in relation to any sort of meaning to life. This position is implied in "regular" nihilism, and existential nihilists may also subscribe to the full nihilistic view, but existential nihilism is still a separate view.

A] Nihilism and existential nihilism are confused with each other for several reasons. Both have Nietzsche as the central philosopher and they have several common traits. One view may even subscribe to the other.

B] Nihilism and existential nihilism are distinct philosophies. They are often confused for two reasons: both have Nietzsche as the central figure; existential nihilism adds to the confusion.

C] Nihilism and existentialism are distinct philosophies. They are often confused because of the Central philosopher Nietzsche and a form of nihilism called existential nihilism containing elements of both.

D] Though Nihilism and existentialism are distinct philosophies, they are often confused because Nietzsche is the central philosopher in both and because of a form of nihilism called existential nihilism containing elements of both.

5. Although the use of a priori to distinguish knowledge such as that which we have in mathematics is comparatively recent, the interest of philosophers in that kind of knowledge is almost as old as philosophy itself. No one finds it puzzling that one can acquire information by looking, feeling, or listening, but philosophers who have taken seriously the possibility of learning by mere thinking have often considered that this requires some special explanation.

A] The distinction between knowledge acquired through thinking and through the senses termed a priori knowledge has always interested philosophers.

B] The distinction between knowledge acquired through thinking termed a priori and through learning has always interested philosophers.

C] The distinction between knowledge acquired through experience and independent of it termed a priori, has always interested philosophers.

D] According to philosophers the knowledge we have in mathematics and the knowledge we acquire through the senses or a priori knowledge require special explanation.

6. In order to communicate effectively with other people, one must have a reasonably accurate idea of what they do and do not know that is pertinent to the communication. Treating people as though they have knowledge that they do not have can result in miscommunication and perhaps

embarrassment. On the other hand, a fundamental rule of conversation, at least according to a Gricean view, is that one generally does not convey to others information that one can assume they already have.

A] Clear communication means to assume the audience has enough knowledge of the subject, or the communication may be inhibited by either confusion or offense

B] Miscommunication happens when we assume people have knowledge when they don't ; hence, if there is to be effective communication one needs to know what people know and what they do not as, even communicating what is already known is against the basic rules of conversation

C] Conveying what people already know causes embarrassment and hence miscommunication occurs as we do not take into account the fact that people do not know what needs to be known

D] Accurate knowledge of what is known and not known helps in better understanding, and communicating what is already known emphasizes the knowledge of the person better

7. Western classical music history is traditionally understood as beginning with plainchant (also called "Gregorian" chant), the vocal religious practice of the Roman Catholic Church. Limited in pitch range and monophonic (i.e., composed of a single melody with no accompaniment), plainchant was sung largely by monks, nuns, and clerics rather than by professional singers. Plainchant was transmitted by memory until the early 9th century, when the Holy Roman Emperor Charlemagne arranged for it to be notated, and for standardized plainchant books to be distributed to churches and monasteries across Europe.

A] Plainchant was devised by Emperor Charlemagne when he realized that there were no available notations for plainchants

B] Western classical music started with the introduction of plainchant but only in the 9th century did it become available worldwide because of the efforts of Emperor Charlemagne

C] Plainchant was originally sung by professional singers and only after notations were developed during Emperor Charlemagne reign did it become freely available to churches, and then did nuns, monks and clerics sing the plainchant

D] Plainchant, the beginning of the western classical music history, was not sung by professional singers but by the church personnel, and until Emperor Charlemagne got the plainchant notated and standardized books distributed to churches and monasteries across Europe, it was passed on by memory

8. The use of words is, of course, primarily social, for the purpose of suggesting to others ideas which we entertain or at least wish them to entertain. But the aspect of words that specially concerns us is their power of promoting our own thought. Almost all higher intellectual activity is a matter of words, to the nearly total exclusion of everything else. The advantages of words for purposes of thought are so great that I should never end if I were to enumerate them.

A] Words are essentially thoughts

B] Words are the most essential vehicle for conveying thoughts

C] Words are the primary method for conveying as well as entertaining thoughts

D] Thoughts are inhibited if one does not have a good vocabulary

9. When a dog approaches a strange dog or man in a savage or hostile frame of mind he walks upright and very stiffly; his head is slightly raised, or not much lowered; the tail is held erect, and quite rigid; the hairs bristle, especially along the neck and back; the pricked ears are directed forwards, and the eyes have a fixed stare. As he prepares to spring with a savage growl on his enemy, the

canine teeth are uncovered, and the ears are pressed close backwards on the head. Let us now suppose that the dog suddenly discovers that the man he is approaching, is not a stranger, but his master; and let it be observed how completely and instantaneously his whole bearing is reversed. Instead of walking upright, the body sinks downwards; his tail, instead of being held stiff and upright, is lowered and wagged from side to side; his hair instantly becomes smooth; his ears are depressed and drawn backwards, but not closely to the head; and his lips hang loosely. From the drawing back of the ears, the eyelids become elongated, and the eyes no longer appear round and staring. It should be added that the animal is at such times in an excited condition from joy; and nerve-force will be generated in excess, which naturally leads to action of some kind.

A] The passive-aggressive nature of dogs is hard to predict
B] The response of dogs is driven by impulse and emotions such as familiarity, in a way similar to humans
C] Dogs are emotionally unstable and can flip in a manner of minutes
D] Dogs and their thought processes can be understood easily from the physical movements

10. To what extent can the State decide what 'Indian society' is, and is not, ready for 'this' becomes a particularly important issue in the reform of laws that affect the everyday lives of men, women and children, like the decriminalization of homosexuality or the abolition of child marriage. In the case of the former, two successive political regimes have hedged the issue with vague noises of societal unreadiness. The National Democratic Alliance government took it upon itself to declare, presumably on behalf of the Indian 'majority', that the "floodgates" of vice would be opened if homosexuality were to be legalized. The Congress-led government has been less direct. With the reforming of the Child Marriage (Restraint) Act, 1929, there seems to be a divide between the Centre's opinion and the views of the NGOs consulted by the government on the matter. The more 'traditional' elements in the government do not want the law to have the power to make child marriages void. But the social workers want full abolition, rendering under-age unions automatically invalid.

A] In India, the State decides, in a surreptitious manner, the direction that needs to be taken by society and enforces its will through laws of its own
B] In India, the State in general does not adopt harsh stand on contentious issues, and hedges its bets in order to avoid particularly dicey issues such as homosexuality
C] In India, the State does adopt a role in gauging the state of society and framing legal prerogatives accordingly, and at times finds itself in situations where it may not be in agreement with all stakeholders
D] In India, the State, crippled by divisions in society and decentralization among various stakeholders, generally adopts the middle path of not ruffling too many feathers, and ends up postponing vital action that can have suitable impact on society

11. What is the object of medical education? It is to enable the practitioner, on the one hand, to prevent disease by his knowledge of hygiene; on the other hand, to divine its nature, and to alleviate or cure it, by his knowledge of pathology, therapeutics, and practical medicine. That is his business in life, and if he has not a thorough and practical knowledge of the conditions of health, of the causes which tend to the establishment of disease, of the meaning of symptoms, and of the uses of medicines and operative appliances, he is incompetent, even if he were the best anatomist, or physiologist, or chemist, that ever took a gold medal or won a prize certificate. This is one great truth respecting medical education.

A] Medical science is not as simple as it seems and it poses the intricate challenge of being able to identify, prevent and cure diseases to the medical practitioner

B] Medical practice is a simple science dealing with the identification, prevention and cure of diseases and doctors often forget this simple precept

C] Practitioner of medicine need not focus on individual gains as long as they are able to expel diseases from their very root of existence

D] Prevention and alleviation of diseases are the two holistic measures that drive the efficacy of a practitioner of medicine

12. There are times when the night sky glows with bands of colour. The bands may begin as cloud shapes and then spread into a great arc across the entire sky. They may fall in folds like a curtain drawn across the heavens. The lights usually grow brighter, then suddenly dim. During this time the sky glows with pale yellow, pink, green, violet, blue, and red. These lights are called the Aurora Borealis. Some people call them the Northern Lights. Scientists have been watching them for hundreds of years. They are not quite sure what causes them. In ancient times people were afraid of the Lights. They imagined that they saw fiery dragons in the sky. Some even concluded that the heavens were on fire.

A] The Aurora Borealis are bands of colour that form shapes in the sky and have been watched by scientists for many years, thinking them to be fiery dragons in the sky

B] For hundreds of years the scientists observed the Northern Lights, also called Aurora Borealis, but could make nothing out of them

C] The Aurora Borealis, or Northern Lights, are bands of colour in the night sky, whom the ancient people thought to be fiery dragons or heavens on fire, and whom scientists observed over centuries but were unable to understand them

D] Scientists have been watching the Aurora Borealis, or Northern Lights for millennia, and so have ancient people who thought them to be fire emitting dragons or fire emitted from the heavens

13. Consider the history of physics. Once upon a time, and more than once, physicists thought they had the universe solved. Some obscure details remained, but the basic structure of the cosmos was understood. Out of this naïveté, relativity theory emerged, fundamentally altering classical notions about the relationship of time and space. Then came Heisenberg's uncertainty principle and the surreal revelations of quantum physics. String theorists, in their attempts to reconcile ever widening theoretical gaps, started talking about eleven dimensions. Dark matter still makes no sense. Modern physics knows so much more about the universe, but there is still so much it doesn't understand. For the first time, some scientists are openly wondering if we, in fact, are incapable of figuring out the cosmos.

A] Scientists, sickened by their failure to resolve the mysteries of life, have to accept defeat

B] Scientists, met by sudden surprises and developments, have to accept that have failed and will always fail.

C] Scientists, blinded by the larger unsolvable puzzles, have to at last lay down their cudgels and accept the mystery of life

D] Scientists, forever challenged by new discoveries, may at last have to accept the unsolvable nature of the cosmos' mysteries

14. Today, political writing is evolving and a new method of expression has come into existence. Examples can be found in speeches, official documents and even the literature produced by academic institutions and charities. It has already spread into mainstream journalism, changing not just political writing, but also sports journalism, foreign reporting and column writing. The new method of expression has become the dominant form in blogs and social media. It rejects

conventional rules of grammar, and is no longer concerned with accuracy and truth. Indeed the worst political writing of the last century, from both Left and Right, stemmed from the writers' assumption that their politics was grounded in scientific truth and they assumed they were describing the outside world objectively. The modern school has turned this assumption on its head. Instead of objectivity, it concentrates its attention on subjective experience. Instead of reason, it values emotion. Where once writers maintained distance from their subject matter, the new sensibility demands intimacy.

A] The modern form of subjective reporting, propelled by new methods of expression such as blogs and social media, has overshadowed the objective writing of the past

B] The modern subjective form of political writing has abandoned the supposedly objective writing style of the last century and has infiltrated all forms of expression

C] The modern form of writing, a strict departure from objectivity of the past, has found a subjective form of expression for itself

D] The modern writer, forever hassled by the demands of subjectivity, has developed an expression that caters to the masses by appealing to their emotions

15. Strategy is about choice, which affects outcomes. Organizations can often do well for periods of time in conditions of relative stability, low environmental turbulence and little competition for resources. Virtually none of these conditions prevail in the modern world for great lengths of time for any organization or sector, public or private. Hence, the rationale for strategic management. The nature of the strategy adopted and implemented emerges from a combination of the structure of the organization, the type of resources available and the nature of the coupling it has with the environment and the strategic objective being pursued. Strategy is adaptable by nature rather than a rigid set of instructions. In some situations it takes the nature of emergent strategy. The simplest explanation of this is the analogy of a sports scenario. If a football team were to organize a plan in which the ball is passed in a particular sequence between specifically positioned players, their success would be dependent on each of those players both being present at the exact location, and remembering exactly when, from whom and to whom the ball is to be passed; moreover that no interruption to the sequence occurs. By comparison, if the team were to simplify this plan to a strategy where the ball is passed in the pattern alone, between any of the team, and at any area on the field, then their vulnerability to variables is greatly reduced, and the opportunity to operate in that manner occurs far more often. This manner is a strategy.

A] Strategic management is required for organizations to succeed in a rapidly changing world where there are several parameters affecting success. Strategy is adaptable in nature rather than being rigid.

B] Every organization in every sector, whether public or private needs a strategy to overcome situations that arise out of changes in the environment. It is not however easy to identify a common strategy for all organizations.

C] The need for strategic management arises because of the variability of the parameters affecting organizations and sectors. The nature of strategy depends on structure, resources and the environment. Strategy is adaptable rather than a rigid set of instructions.

D] Strategy differs from one organization to another depending upon the structure of the organization, its goals and relation with the environment. Without a strategy it is not possible to survive in an ever-changing world.

16. Charisma proves surprisingly hard to identify in advance. A recent survey concluded that "relatively little" is known about who charismatic leaders are. Charisma is the most elusive of political traits, because it doesn't exist in reality; only in our perception once a candidate has made it by hard work

and good issues. Similarly, the business press has described many a CEO as "charismatic" when things are going well, only to withdraw the label when profits fall.

A] In politics as in business charisma is not identifiable in advance but is based on our perception of how one has made it by hard work and good issues.

B] Charismatic political or business leaders are hard to identify and do not exist in reality as charisma is based on how one has made it by hard work and good issues.

C] Charisma is the most elusive of business and political traits and does not exist in reality, but is based on how we perceive success through hard work and good causes.

D] In politics as in business charisma is not identifiable in advance but is based on our perception of one's success or failure in the world.

17. Since the beginning of the development of microwave wireless transmission equipment, manufacturers and operators have tried to mitigate the effects of reflected signals associated with signal propagation. These reflections are called multipath. In real-world situations, microwave systems involve careful design to overcome the effects of multipath. Most existing multipath mitigation approaches fall well short of the full reliable information rate potential of many wireless communications systems.

A] Microwave wireless communications systems and operators endeavour to reduce the effects of reflected signals during signal propagation. Most systems are inadequate.

B] Microwave systems involve careful design to overcome the effects of multipath or reflected signals. None of the approaches are entirely successful.

C] The efforts to overcome multiplepaths are factors in the design and operation of microwave systems. Generally, a reliable information rate is not achieved.

D] The mitigation of the effects of multipath associated with signal propagation is a part of the design and operation of microwave systems to achieve the full reliable information rate.

18. The Great Depression (also known in the U.K. as the Great Slump) was a dramatic, worldwide economic downturn beginning in some countries as early as 1928. The beginning of the Great Depression in the United States is associated with the stock market crash on October 29, 1929, known as Black Tuesday. The depression had devastating effects in both the industrialized countries and those, which exported raw materials. International trade declined sharply, as did personal incomes, tax revenues, prices, and profits. Cities all around the world were hit hard, especially those dependent on heavy industry. Construction was virtually halted in many countries. Farming and rural areas suffered as crop prices fell by 40 to 60 percent. Facing plummeting demand with few alternate sources of jobs, areas dependent on primary sector industries such as farming, mining and logging suffered the most. At the time, Herbert Hoover was President of the United States.

A] A stock market crash in October of 1929 triggered the Great Depression at a time when Herbert Hoover was the President of USA. Due to this crash the primary and industrial sectors were affected, which in turn affected countries and cities that were dependent on them. The farming sectors in all countries lost the most number of jobs.

B] The Great Depression affected both industrialized and non-industrialized countries alike. Cities all around the world that depended on heavy industry were affected. International trade declined and so did incomes and tax revenues. The other sectors that faced the brunt were farming and construction.

C] The Great Depression, a worldwide economic downturn, started in the USA with a stock market crash in 1929 when Herbert Hoover was the President. Industrialized and non-industrialized countries were hit badly along with cities that were dependent on heavy

industry. The depression also affected international trade, construction, farming and areas that were dependent on primary sector industries.

D] A sudden decline in the farming and construction sectors in non-industrialized countries triggered one of the biggest downturns in world economy. It was 1929, when Herbert Hoover was the President of USA that the effects of the Great Depression were seen in the stock markets in the USA. Slowly the countries and cities that were dependent on heavy industry and primary sectors were also badly affected.

19. In March 1942, faced with an increasingly dissatisfied sub-continent only reluctantly participating in the war, and deteriorations in the war situation in Europe and South East Asia, and with growing dissatisfaction among Indian troops- especially in Europe- and among the civilian population in the sub-continent, the British government sent a delegation to India under Stafford Cripps, in what came to be known as the Cripps' Mission. The purpose of the mission was to negotiate with the Indian National Congress a deal to obtain total co-operation during the war, in return for progressive devolution and distribution of powers from the crown and the Viceroy to the elected Indian legislature. However, the talks failed, having failed to address the key demand of a timeframe towards self-government, and of definition of the powers to be relinquished, essentially portraying an offer of limited dominion-status that was wholly unacceptable to the Indian movement.

A] In 1942, the British government lost control of its troops and was having a tough time in the Second World War. Under Stafford Cripps, the Cripps' Mission was negotiating with the Indian National Congress for its support in the war and asked them for more troops and to talk to their soldiers in Europe. The mission was largely successful and the Indian National Congress won self-rule.

B] During the Second World War, the Indian National Congress asked the British government to give India self rule. The British wanted India to support them in the war and sent a delegation under Stafford Cripps, called the Cripps' mission, but was not successful in getting India to support them.

C] Due to the lack of India's support in the war and the growing dissatisfaction among Indian soldiers in Europe, the British government, in 1942 sent the Cripps' mission. The main objective of the mission was to get full co-operation from Indian National Congress in the war, in return for transfer of power to the elected Indian Legislature. However, the talks failed as it failed to address the key demand of self-government.

D] The Indian National Congress was not pleased to see the situation of the British in the war. So the Cripps' Mission was called in order to negotiate Indian support for the war in return for complete independence and the shift of power to the elected Indian legislature. The talks failed as the British did not address self-rule.

20. In for-profit work, management has as its primary function the satisfaction of a range of stakeholders. This typically involves making a profit (for the shareholders), creating valued products at a reasonable cost (for customers), and providing rewarding employment opportunities (for employees). In non-profit management, add the importance of keeping the faith of donors. In most models of management/governance, shareholders vote for the board of directors, and the board then hires senior management. Some organizations have experimented with other methods (such as employee-voting models) of selecting or reviewing managers; but this occurs only very rarely. In countries constituted as representative democracies, voters elect politicians to public office. Such politicians hire many managers and administrators, and in some countries like the United States political appointees lose their jobs on the election of a new

President/Governor/Mayor. Some 2500 people serve at the pleasure of the United States Chief Executive, including all of the top US government executives.

A] The United States is a perfect example of a representative democracy in which people vote for politicians to enter public office. They then hire managers who may lose their jobs after the next election if someone else is elected to power.

B] Non-profit management is considerably tougher than for-profit management since it also has to consider donors along with other stakeholders. In public office however senior management is bound to change as it is appointed by elected politicians.

C] For-profit management has to generate a profit for shareholders, create valuable products and services for customers and develop opportunities for employees. Politicians in public office however can appoint or dismiss any government executive after they are elected. This is the case in several representative democracies like the USA.

D] Management in for-profit work has to satisfy shareholders, customers and employees. Non-profit management has to consider donors too. In most models, shareholders vote for directors who hire senior management. In representative democracies people elect politicians, who then hire managers who may be dependent on elections.

21. Thousands of officials from all over the world met for two weeks of difficult talks in Bonn under the United Nations' climate convention. But they were conscious that even more difficult and probably more important negotiations were under way in Beijing. America's most senior climate-change officials were meeting their Chinese counterparts. The two countries are by far the world's biggest emitters of greenhouse gases. They will determine whether a worthwhile global treaty to limit emissions can be concluded as planned in Copenhagen in December. The treaty is to replace the Kyoto protocol, which expires in 2012. Some 180 countries will take part in the negotiations, but many feel that, on this issue more than any other, China and America make up a "G2" that determines the global post-Kyoto agenda.

A] The United Nations' climate convention may not be able to determine the global post-Kyoto agenda on green house gases unless China and America jointly ratifies it.

B] In 2012, China and America, the two biggest emitters of green house gases have the potential to determine the global post-Kyoto agenda to limit emissions.

C] At the next United Nations' climate convention, China and America, the two biggest emitters of green house gases, will determine the global post-Kyoto agenda to limit emissions.

D] At the next United Nations' climate convention, China and America, the two biggest emitters of green house gases, will determine the global post-Kyoto agenda to limit emissions, overriding 180 other nations.

22. The monarchy enjoys a special, quasi-religious, role in Thai society; and the king is widely and deeply revered. Mostly, the foreign media have censored themselves and, fully aware of the sensitivities, avoided all but the most fawningly positive reports. But in our view, this has become unsustainable, for two reasons. First, King Bhumibol Adulyadej turned 81 in December, and has been frail. His heir-apparent, the crown prince, does not enjoy the same standing. The looming succession is an important political issue and cannot simply be ignored. Second, last year saw Thailand descend into something close to mob rule. Protesters against the elected government took over airports, dealing a terrible blow to the important tourist industry in the process. They did so in the name of the king, and the royal family never repudiated them.

A] In the light of the mob rule condoned by the ruling monarchy in Thailand, it has become difficult for foreign media to publish anything favourable to the ruling monarchy.

B] Foreign media can no more publish the positive reports about the ruling monarchy in Thailand because of the recent protest against the democratic government which was condoned by the monarchy.

C] The impending succession in Thailand's monarchy is politically significant as the crown prince does not enjoy the kind of reverence that King Bhumibol Adulyadej enjoyed. Foreign media are hence not censoring themselves.

D] The fawningly positive reports of foreign media towards Thailand's monarchy have become unsustainable in the light of the impending succession and the monarchy's undemocratic postures.

Directions for questions 23 to 34: In the given paragraph, the last line has been deleted. Choose the option that logically follows the paragraph.

23. Even before the White House and the Republicans began talks on the debt limit, John Boehner made clear that he was looking for a political fight, not a compromise. Then, in a speech on Monday, the speaker of the House said that Republicans would insist on trillions of dollars in spending cuts in exchange for votes to raise the debt limit. He did not mention a time frame, but even a fraction of "trillions" in the near term could do huge damage to the recovery. He also did not offer specifics on how he planned to make those cuts. After the beating Republicans took for their plan to slash Medicare, he clearly decided generalities were politically safer. There is no way to solve the country's fiscal ills without an accurate diagnosis and rigorous prescriptions for a cure. _____.

A] Mr. Boehner's speech was devoid of both

B] Mr. Boehner's speech tried to find a middle path for both but failed

C] Mr. Boehner's speech was a valiant but flawed attempt to address these issues through rhetoric

D] Mr. Boehner's speech over-shot this ambit of discussion and went on altogether unwanted path.

24. Physicscan be beautiful. Read Newton or Einstein. Or you could play Portal 2, the achingly brilliant new game from the Valve Corporation that wrings more fun out of physics than all of the shoot-'em-ups in the world. Warning: This is a brain game. If you don't consider thinking hard to be an entertainment experience, Portal 2 is not for you. It will not test your reflexes or eye-hand coordination. _____.

A] What it will test is true ability to think and the conversion of those thoughts into action

B] What it will create is a surreal world in the mind where your capabilities of cognition and physical activity are stretched to the limit

C] It will rather pose a strenuous challenge of using your mind as using your reflexes and eye-hand coordination

D] What it will test, in knee-slapping and grin-inducing fashion, is your mind

25. Diesel fuel is very similar to heating oil which is used in central heating. In Europe, the United States, and Canada, taxes on diesel fuel are higher than on heating oil due to the fuel tax, and in those areas, heating oil is marked with fuel dyes and trace chemicals to prevent and detect tax fraud. Similarly, "untaxed" diesel (sometimes called "off road diesel") is available in the United States, which is available for use primarily in agricultural applications such as fuel for tractors, recreational and utility vehicles or other noncommercial vehicles that do not use public roads.

Additionally, this fuel may have sulphur levels that exceed the limits for road use using the newer 2007 standards. _____

A] Therefore, vehicles that use this untaxed diesel are not allowed to travel on public roads.
B] This untaxed diesel is dyed red for identification purposes.
C] Thus, this type of diesel fuel is gradually being phased out.
D] Thus, vehicles that use this untaxed diesel must have a catalytic converter fitted into them so as to comply with this new standard.

26. NSE's Nifty index closed below 4,000 points yesterday, first time since the election result took it past that mark on May 18. The immediate trigger is obviously the budget, which apparently did not meet many of the street's expectations the securities transactions tax remained, there was no change in corporate tax rates and there was no big push to reforms. Yet, given the economic backdrop, it is difficult to imagine what more the budget could have done. The overwhelming priority at this stage is reviving the economy, and the budget tries to do just that. _____

A] Crude oil price has dropped drastically from its recent highs.
B] Good time for a hard look at existing investments and asset allocation.
C] The market had built up irrational expectations from the budget.
D] The index has shed a large part of the gains made over the past couple of months.

27. Individuals owed their existence to their parents; without their countless sacrifices, they would never survive nor grow into sane human beings. They realised their potential in a stable and peaceful society, made possible by the efforts of thousands of anonymous men and women. They became rational, reflective and moral beings within a rich civilisation created by scores of sages, saints, savants and scientists. _____.

A] Even a whole lifetime was not enough to pay back what they owed their parents, let alone all the others.
B] In short, every human being owed his humanity to others and benefitted from a world, to the creation of which he had not contributed anything.
C] To talk about 'repaying' the debts did not therefore make sense except in a clumsy and metaphorical way of describing one's response to unsolicited but indispensable gifts.
D] Every individual is born with a debt, which is beyond his capacity to repay.

28. A century and a half ago, Charles Darwin detailed his theory of evolution by natural selection in his book 'On the Origin of Species'. How does this remarkably successful theory apply to life on our planet? How have the scientists of subsequent generations built on Darwin's ideas? _____.

A] Darwin's general theory presumes the development of life from non-life and stresses a purely naturalistic (undirected) "descent with modification".
B] And can Darwin's theory of Evolution be aligned with the evolutionary worldview, which is as old as antiquity?
C] Natural selection is the preservation of a functional advantage that enables a species to compete better in the wild
D] And does revisiting the original theory shed new light on the remaining puzzles?

29. What's interesting is that very little of the outrage focuses on the assassination itself. By now, the West has accepted that Israelis will track down and assassinate terrorists no matter where in the world they hide. And, in the post 9/11 era, few people seem to mind. It is widely accepted that terrorists can rarely be brought to justice and convicted by courts of law. _____

A] Last month an 11-member hit team dispatched by Israel's Mossad travelled to Dubai and assassinated Mahmoud al-Mabhouh, a Hamas military commander.
B] All this has lessons for India.
C] So, an assassination often seems like the most effective option.
D] America infiltrates terror groups, encourages them to fight with each other, kidnaps and whisks away important terrorists.

30. As society often reminds us, a woman never really has a home to call her own. As a young girl she lives in her father's home and as a married lady, she occupies her husband's. So, which is the home she can rightfully claim as hers? The answer is obvious – the one she buys for herself. More and more women are making this crucial decision and putting down their own money for a roof over their heads. _____
A] From sweepers to surgeon, women in the workforce are increasingly breaking away from past tyrannies and asserting their right to live life on their own terms.
B] It frees them from that ghastly insecurity of staying in relationships that may not be in their interest.
C] 'My house...my card...my pc...my money....'— the operative word here is 'my'.
D] This new equation is not restricted to 'people like us' – this change is cutting across all divides.

31. Here are a few scenes from a revolution: In early February, Barack Obama ended a six-month press conference drought by taking questions from YouTube. When a madman crashed his plane into a Texas office building a couple of weeks later, the White House responded on its blog. _____
A] In response, Obama's advisers have had to remake the rules of presidential p.r.
B] But the White House has proved to be a harder perch from which to dominate the conversation.
C] During the 2008 campaign, Obama's team had been able to exploit new technologies as no political campaign had before.
D] And during the bipartisan summit on health reform, press secretary Robert Gibbs used Twitter to keep score.

32. The recent decision of the government of India to impose a moratorium on the release of Bt-Brinjal has been hailed by civil society and scientists alike as a victory for transparency and has demonstrated that the government is responsive to societal demands. This decision is also important since it could set a precedent within environmental regulation with reference to technologies with significant environmental risks. _____
A] This establishes a clear case for ensuring legal certainty in environmental regulations especially in the case of technologies with significant risks attached to it.
B] The process of arriving at this decision had also attracted a fair share of media attention, given its 'sensational' nature.
C] However, the decision also reflects a clear departure from procedure and its legal basis is tenuous and therefore the risk of it being reversed remains.
D] The world is waiting, with fingers crossed (or pointed?), as to what this decision would mean for farmers across the world.

33. Many insulters perform small actions which make them appear pompous or 'superior' the most obvious example is the tilting back of the head, combined with half-closed eyes, which has given

rise to the popular expressions 'look down upon', 'turn one's nose up' and 'look down one's nose'. This is an exaggerated version of one of the basic high-status signals. In ordinary status displays the more dominant carry their heads high, the more submissive hang their heads low. _____

A] The high/low difference is usually rather slight- so slight that we are rarely aware of it consciously.
B] Unconsciously, however, we are highly responsive even to minute difference in 'uprightness'.
C] This behaviour is usually a symptom of some hidden insecurity in the insulter.
D] Displays such as these have also been observed in certain animal species, which have a more developed social structure.

34. It is simply absurd to accuse someone in Indian politics of autocracy and undemocratic behavior because our entire political culture has been undemocratic (leader-centric) and hypocritical. As the veteran politician, the late P V Narasimha Rao candidly wrote in his memoirs, our political culture has always been feudal at the core, where the leader assumed all powers. Intra-party democracy never existed in any party. This country, proclaiming itself a republic, vesting sovereignty in its people, actually practises the worst kind of concentration of power in a supreme leader. Can there be any greater hypocrisy than this? It began right at the dawn of self-rule: Mahatma Gandhi, the supreme leader of the Congress chose Nehru to be the king and simply asked other contenders like Sardar Patel and Maulana Azad to endorse his choice. _____

A] Barring a few short preludes, when, for instance, Lal Bahadur Shastri or Narasimha Rao became prime minister (albeit not for democratic reasons), for a large part of its post-independence period, India has been ruled by the Nehru dynasty.
B] Indian politics is not new to this; for instance in the Mahabharata the entire 'epic' unfolds as a result of unstinted power vested in the hands of a leader.
C] There is practically no accountability of the leaders to anyone except the token concern for their voters at the end of five years, which is also at best a momentary surge and not an underlying principle.
D] It is again a corollary of the feudal political culture that makes the leader assume all powers to do whatever he or she likes and certainly, Mayawati is not the one who set the precedent.

Directions for questions 35 to 41: Each of the following questions consists of a highlighted sentence and a paragraph from which it may have been taken. Each paragraph has four numbered blanks, indicating the possible locations from which the highlighted sentence could have been taken. Choose the number of the blank where the highlighted sentence can best be reinserted and key in that number in the input box provided below the question paragraph. If you think that the highlighted sentence is contextually unrelated or does not belong to the given paragraph, then write [E] as your answer.

35. **This taciturn tendency has long bemused people trying to understand the direction of China's monetary policy.**

Alan Greenspan was a master of abstruse language as chairman of the Federal Reserve. "If you understood what I said, I must have misspoken," he once joked. At least Mr Greenspan spoke. In China, the central bank has made a habit of silence. Policy announcements are rare and, if they are offered, come at unpredictable hours, often over the weekend. _____(A)_____ Sudden shifts in the value of the yuan always bear the central bank's fingerprints, but are infrequently explained. The motto for the People's Bank of China (PBOC) should be: "If you know what we did, we must

have done it wrong". _____ (B) _____ But recently it has reached new and dangerous extremes. Since June the central bank is widely reported to have injected as much as 1.8 trillion yuan ($294 billion) to prop up the slowing economy through a mix of targeted liquidity facilities. _____(C)_____ That is a lot of money, equivalent to more than three months of quantitative easing at the peak of the Fed's bond buying programme. But only in early November, half a year after rumours started, did the central bank provide some confirmation of its actions, and even then it was only partial. _____(D)_____

36. **More generally, years of kleptocracy have had a corrosive effect on Russia.**
_____(A)_____ Vladimir Putin is not short of problems, many of his own creation. There is the carnage in eastern Ukraine, where he is continuing to stir things up. There are his fraught relations with the West, with even Germany turning against him now. There is an Islamist insurgency on his borders and at home there is grumbling among the growing numbers who doubt the wisdom of his Ukraine policy. But one problem could yet eclipse all these: Russia's wounded economy could fall into a crisis. _____(B)_____ Some of Russia's ailments are well known. Its oil fired economy surged upward on rising energy prices; now that oil has tumbled, from an average of almost $110 a barrel in the first half of the year to below $80, Russia is hurting. More than two thirds of exports come from energy. _____(C)_____ The rouble has fallen by 23% in three months. Western sanctions have also caused pain, as bankers have applied the restrictions not just to Mr Putin's cronies, but to a much longer tally of Russian businesses. _____(D)_____ Much of the country's wealth has been divided among Mr Putin's friends.

37. **They were not the solid masses, all clogs and snap tins.**
"Common People" is an extraordinary piece of research. "Every life deserves telling," says Ms Light, an English literature professor at Newcastle University. "None is without drama and change." But few of her family left any trace beyond census returns and registrations of baptism, marriage and death. _____(A)_____ Hunting through the records, she longs for something more: "I wanted some distinguishing features," she confesses, "some sign of an inner life." But the point of her book lies not so much in its individual characters as in the patterns they make. _____(B)_____ They were constantly on the move, tramping the roads, in and out of employment, sliding around the social scale. A telephone clerk becomes a railway porter; a bricklayer becomes a navy cook's mate; a schoolmaster's daughter sews shirts; a master baker becomes a grocer and dies in the workhouse. _____(C) _____ These people are blown about by private and political circumstance–figures "in the carpet woven by events, by chance and accident, and by the play of forces larger than us." _____(D)_____

38. **This is not merely rhetoric.**
The sheep in "Animal Farm" repeat the slogan, "Four legs good, two legs bad". In the management world these days, the chant is "Long termism good, short termism bad". _____ (A) _____ The Harvard Business Review constantly thunders against the evils of short termism. Bosses of listed companies give off the record briefings to journalists bemoaning shareholders' inability to see beyond the ends of their noses. _____ (B) _____ In the continental European model of capitalism, long termism means that businesses will prosper by pursuing the enduring interests of all their "stakeholders", workers and suppliers included. More recently, supporters of Anglo Saxon capitalism have produced a variant of this argument: firms will enjoy sustained growth if they favour the interests of long term shareholders over traders who hold stock for briefer periods. _____ (C) _____ Policymakers in France and America are actually drawing up plans to give

long term investors or shareholders more shares, extra voting power/ rights and huge tax incentives. _____ (D) _____

39. **The ploy is not working.**
China's president, Xi Jinping, is unlikely to quote Thucydides when he meets his American counterpart, Barrack Obama, at a summit in California in December 2016. But the spirit of the Greek historian will hover over the Sunnylands ranch. Chinese policy wonks are struck by his argument that it was the Spartans' fear of the growing power of Athens that made war inevitable. _____(A)_____. Their insistence that China wants a "peaceful rise" is intended to calm such worries in America. _____(B)_____. China's relations with America have deteriorated in recent years, raising the spectre of conflict in East Asia. Buoyed up by its own economic success and Western stagnation, China has been asserting its claims in the regions more aggressively, sending the neighbours scuttling back to the American security umbrella. _____(C)_____. Barack Obama's response has been a "pivot" towards Asia. In the absence of trust, both sides will build up their military strength and responsible defensive behaviour could spiral into conflict. _____(D)_____.

40. **There is, of course, a connection between the two.**
"Onward, upward, and inward" is my favourite motto. And inward is my favourite escape. What makes it all the more special is that going inward is both an escape and the ultimate reality. I completely get the sense of wonder that has led men and women through the ages to explore outer space, but personally I have always been much more fascinated with exploring inner space. _____(A)_____ Astronauts have often reported transformational experiences when they have looked back at Earth, a phenomenon that has been called "the overview effect." But, as Thomas Merton put it, "What can we gain by sailing to the Moon if we are not able to cross the abyss that separates us from ourselves? _____(B)_____ This is the most important of all voyages of discovery, and without it all the rest are not only useless but disastrous." Marcus Aurelius called that place I love escaping to our "inner citadel". And, being both the emperor of Rome and a stoic philosopher, he clearly demonstrated that you could escape into your inner citadel and rule an empire at the same time. _____(C)_____ You can be in the world, but not of the world" . _____(D)_____

41. **Closer to home, the European Union finds it harder to exert influence – even over its neighbourhood.**
All of Europe rejoiced when the European Space Agency deposited Philae, a probe the size of a kitchen appliance, on the surface of a comet 300 miles (480 m km) from the earth. It was like throwing a dart blindfolded across an ocean and hitting the bullseye. _____(A)_____ Philae fell silent soon afterwards, but not before dispatching reams of data and a shot of optimism to a continent that has had little to cheer. _____(B)_____ Russia's intervention in Ukraine is providing an early test for the EU's new high representative for foreign policy, Federica Mogherini, who previously served as Italy's foreign minister. NATO is warning of a renewed buildup of Russian troops and kit in eastern Ukraine. _____(C)_____ The recent sham elections in two proRussian separatist regions in the Donbas were "respected" if not recognized by Moscow. Petro Poroshenko, Ukraine's president, is preparing for "total war". _____(D)_____

ADVANCED VRC03
Paragraph Summary, Theme Completion
Home Sheet

Time: 60 minutes

Directions for questions 1 to 18: From among the options, choose the summary of the passage that is written in the same style as that of the passage.

1. Some parts of America have long taken a tough, frontier attitude to justice. That tendency sharpened around four decades ago as rising crime became an emotive political issue and voters took to backing politicians who promised to stamp on it. This created a ratchet effect: lawmakers who wish to sound tough must propose laws tougher than the ones that the last chap who wanted to sound tough proposed. When the crime rate falls, tough sentences are hailed as the cause, even when demography or other factors may matter more; when the rate rises tough sentences are demanded to solve the problem. As a result, America's incarceration rate has quadrupled since 1970.
   A] America's incarceration rate has been a key factor in controlling crime and is therefore supported by both the voters and politicians.
   B] A tough attitude towards rising crime is the only long-term solution to the problem and some parts of America have implemented it successfully.
   C] In America, increasingly tougher laws are perceived as the only effective factor in lowering the crime rate despite other factors being important.
   D] As the crime rate rose, voters started supporting tougher laws and this has led to the government making ever more stringent regulations in certain parts of America.

2. There is no doubt that anonymity leads people to act out in ways they normally wouldn't. For many, this means increased anti-social behaviour and, in comments sections, an uncharacteristic tendency to insult and attack. Diane Mapes wrote a good column on this two years ago, in which she noted that faceless communication leads to disinhibition, whether its online, in a car or on the phone with a customer-service representative. "Between out-of-control customers, vituperative online posters and road-raging drivers, it's hard to find an individual who hasn't succumbed to the siren song of faceless, consequence-free communication," she wrote. Psychologists even have a name for the online phenomenon: "online disinhibition effect".
   A] The roots of the online disinhibition effect lie in the anti-social behaviour of people.
   B] Anonymity encourages people to display their natural instincts of anti-social behaviour.
   C] When communication is anonymous people frequently display anti-social behaviour.
   D] Online disinhibition effect leads to out-of-control customers, vituperative online posters and roadraging drivers.

3. Economists face two competing criticisms. Either they are lambasted for their arrogance or accused of being unwilling to draw firm conclusions (in exasperation at the hedging of his economic adviser, President Harry Truman requested a one handed economist). Dani Rodrik of Harvard University, drawing on an idea from Isaiah Berlin, splits economists into two camps: hedgehogs and foxes. Hedgehogs take a single idea and apply it to every problem they come across. Foxes have no grand vision but lots of seemingly contradictory views, as they tailor their conclusions to the situation. More foxlike behaviour will not by itself prevent the next crisis; politicians anyway will still be making the decisions. But it could help policymakers be better prepared.

A] The world has seen two types of economists: hedgehogs and foxes. Their hedgehog or foxlike behaviour is what they face criticism for. Because of the hedging of his economic adviser, President Harry Truman requested a one handed economist.

B] There are two types of economists: hedgehogs and foxes. Hedgehogs are stubborn in nature. Foxes are able to draw a firm conclusion after a lot of dillydallying.

C] On the one hand, economists can be single minded like hedgehogs. On the other hand, they can also be likened to foxes. While seemingly having no objective and being unable to make up their minds, this fox like behaviour might help them to be better prepared for a crisis.

D] Economists are of two competing types. Some of them apply a single concept to all problems because they resemble hedgehogs. Others have no vision and are not able to take a fast decision because they resemble foxes.

4. During the sixties, Marshall McLuhan wrote his The *Gutenberg Galaxy*, where he announced that the linear way of thinking, renewed by the invention of the press, was on the verge of being substituted by a more global way of perceiving and understanding through TV images or other kinds of electronic devices. What is curious is that the media started to celebrate the decline of literacy and the overwhelming power of images just at the moment in which, on the world scene, appeared the Computer. The computer is not just an instrument by means of which one can produce and edit images, it has become an alphabetic instrument. On its screen there run words, lines, and in order to use a computer you must be able to write and to read. In this sense one can say that the computer has made us return to a Gutenberg Galaxy. People who spend their night engaging in an unending Internet conversation are principally dealing with words. If the TV screen can be considered a sort of ideal window through which one watches the whole world in the form of images, the computer screen is an ideal book on which one linearly reads about the world in the form of words and pages.

A] When Marshall McLuhan wrote his The *Gutenberg Galaxy*, the media needed a certain time to accept the idea that our civilization was on the verge of becoming an image oriented one – which would have involved a decline of literacy. But the appearance of the computer has made the media reinforce the belief that literacy is of paramount importance.

B] The classical computer provides a linear sort of written communication. The screen displays written lines. It is like a fast reading book. In this sense the computer made us to return to a Gutenberg Galaxy.

C] The printing press has been replaced with the computer. But the media was wrong to celebrate the decline of literacy as the return of the computer has enabled a return to the Gutenberg Galaxy. The linear way of thinking and reading is here to stay.

D] It seemed that images from television and other electonic devices would take one away from the linear way of thinking brought in by the print medium. But the computer reinforces the need for literacy or a linear manner of thinking and reading as one has to go through the lines and pages on its screen just as one would in a book.

5. Grameen Telecom, Grameen Bank's arm in Bangladesh for administering the village phone operators typically selects women on the basis of past borrowing records with the bank. For instance, if a woman has demonstrated certain skills in learning new things, she is favoured as a candidate for retailing phone service. Another factor is the location of her house; a central location in the village is preferred. Grameen Bank also ensures that at least one member of the family of a village phone operator knows English letters and numbers. There is also a great deal of social impact due to this new service. With some of the poorest women in the villages holding in their hand instruments of global communication, there are ripples in the highly stratified villages. Even a

relatively rich person in the village is walking up to a poor woman's home for a service he needs. The phone service being retailed in these villages almost exclusively by women, a situation due to the fact that 94% of borrowers of the Grameen Bank are women, is turning out to be another good thing. Since it is the men who tend to go to the cities for work or trade or even to foreign countries as migrant workers, it is the women left behind in the villages who need to contact their men travelling or residing outside. The women naturally feel more comfortable going to other women to make phone calls.

A] Women choosing to retail telephone services need only one day of training from Grameen Telecom. Their success in rapid training and in their business has to be at least partly attributed to their general entrepreneurial skills and the confidence they have built through their past income generating businesses with the help of the Grameen Bank.

B] Grameen Bank is implementing a nationwide telecom project to bring about greater connectivity. The women naturally feel more comfortable going to other women in rural areas to make phone calls and the telecom project is bound to be a huge success.

C] Bangladesh's Grameen Bank, via its arm Grameen Telecom, retails phone services in rural areas through village phone operators whom they select carefully – typically women who are constituents of the bank, and whose circumstances will enable them to deliver the services effectively. This new service has significant social impact, especially for poorer women, helping not only the operators but a number of users as well.

D] Grameen Bank is promoting women's empowerment by providing them with telephones, manned exclusively by women. This will also result in social change in rural Bangladesh.

6. As long back as 1891, in 'The Decay of Lying', Oscar Wilde warned artists and critics not to become infatuated with Life at the expense of Art. He wrote: "Art begins with abstract decoration, with purely imaginative and pleasurable work dealing with what is unreal and nonexistent. This is the first stage. Then Life becomes fascinated with this new wonder, and asks to be admitted into the charmed circle. Art takes life as part of its rough material, recreates it, and refashions dreams, and keeps between itself and reality the impenetrable barrier of beautiful style, of decorative or ideal treatment. The third stage is when Life gets the upper hand, and drives Art out into the wilderness. This is the true decadence, and it is from this that we are now suffering." Wilde's words on the decadence of a literary culture attracted to fame, gossip and scandal are just as relevant today. By focussing too much on life in our readings of art, we miss that which is 'purely imaginative and pleasurable' – the element of beauty, music and mystery that differentiates poems and stories from politics and propaganda.

A] The first stage that Art goes though is characterized by pure insight and gratification. In the second stage, the elements from life impregnate art. In the third, life wins over art. Thus each stage takes art closer to the state of moral retrogression.

B] Art goes through three stages. The first stage shows the influence of life in all aspects of life and treatment. The second stage is characterized by purely inventive or visionary themes. In the third stage, life is artless. The third stage is a reflection of decadence prevalent in society.

C] Life has three stages just like art. The first is when art is unreal and enterprising; the second is when art and life perfectly intersperse with each other; the third is when art is thrown out of the window of life. The first two stages of art are a reflection of the decadence in humanity.

D] There are three stages in art – first, when art is unreal, ingenious and gratifying; second, when art admits life into its space, remodels it but maintains its own impregnable style. The

third represents a degenerative state where life relegates art to the periphery. The third stage is reflected in the decadence even now prevalent in the literary sphere.

7. The critical difference in the direction of flow of India's wealth was introduced with the setting up of British rule. The English East India Company which acquired political power in 1757 was not merely another Indian state. Bullion inflow into India was to ease out; instead Indian goods were to be bought by the British from the revenues of Bengal. Initially Bengal and later the revenues of most of the upper provinces were to maintain not only British power but also sustain their Empire. India became a supplier of raw material to British industry and a market for her finished products. This imbalanced relation encouraged a functional relationship with the British. The Britishers on posting to India rarely came with their families. India remained a "posting" for them. Thus in British India not only were salaries and pensions of officers transferred to Britain but the fortunes amassed were also dispatched home to be invested there. The fortunes of the British, acquired legally and illegally, were by no means small. They often earned them the title of oriental Nabobs. The title not only connoted an "Indianised" lifestyle but also the corrupt practices and wealth that Britishers associated with oriental princes.

A] The Indian economy was affected in a major way during the British Raj. India provided only raw materials for the British industries, the profit filled the British coffers and even the salaries and the pensions of the officers was dispatched home, to the British treasuries. The British regarded India only as a posting. The title of oriental Nabobs was conferred on the Britishers by the oriental princes.

B] The East India Company acquired political power, and the revenues of Bengal and the upper provinces began to be used to maintain the British Empire. Indian raw material sustained British industries and profits made in India contributed to the sustenance of British dominance. This imbalanced relation led to a purely functional relationship with the British Raj. To the English of the Raj, India was only a posting where many of them amassed fortunes and were referred to as oriental 'Nabobs', a title that referred not only to their lifestyle, but also to their illgotten wealth.

C] The defining disjunction that the English East India Company rule heralded was the use of the revenues of Bengal for the maintenance of an imbalanced commercial tie between Britain and India. This was particularly true after the industrial revolution of England when bullion inflows into India were considerably lowered; and India became a market for England's finished products. The Britishers regarded India as a home away from home and they earned the title of oriental Nabobs.

D] The Indian economy was affected in a major way during the British Raj. Indian raw material was taken to Britain and finished products were delivered to India. Britain shared a symbiotic relationship with India. But the Britishers never regarded India as their home as had been the case with the Mughal Emperors and nobles who lived here with their families for good.

8. As long back as 1891, in 'The Decay of Lying', Oscar Wilde warned artists and critics not to become infatuated with Life at the expense of Art. He wrote: "Art begins with abstract decoration, with purely imaginative and pleasurable work dealing with what is unreal and nonexistent. This is the first stage. Then Life becomes fascinated with this new wonder, and asks to be admitted into the charmed circle. Art takes life as part of its rough material, recreates it, and refashions dreams, and keeps between itself and reality the impenetrable barrier of beautiful style, of decorative or ideal treatment. The third stage is when Life gets the upper hand, and drives Art out into the wilderness.

This is the true decadence, and it is from this that we are now suffering." Wilde's words on the decadence of a literary culture attracted to fame, gossip and scandal are just as relevant today. By focussing too much on life in our readings of art, we miss that which is 'purely imaginative and pleasurable' – the element of beauty, music and mystery that differentiates poems and stories from politics and propaganda.

A] The first stage that Art goes though is characterized by pure insight and gratification. In the second stage, the elements from life impregnate art. In the third, life wins over art. Thus each stage takes art closer to the state of moral retrogression.

B] Art goes through three stages. The first stage shows the influence of life in all aspects of life and treatment. The second stage is characterized by purely inventive or visionary themes. In the third stage, life is artless. The third stage is a reflection of decadence prevalent in society.

C] Life has three stages just like art. The first is when art is unreal and enterprising; the second is when art and life perfectly intersperse with each other; the third is when art is thrown out of the window of life. The first two stages of art are a reflection of the decadence in humanity.

D] There are three stages in art – first, when art is unreal, ingenious and gratifying; second, when art admits life into its space, remodels it but maintains its own impregnable style. The third represents a degenerative state where life relegates art to the periphery. The third stage is reflected in the decadence even now prevalent in the literary sphere.

9. Is Indian thinking about management, leadership or global strategy shaped by classical Indian literature such as the Bhagavad Gita? The Bhagavad Gita is a wise and wonderful poem, with much thoughful commentary about both the conduct and the examination of life. The philosophical ideas it encapsulates have had a pervasive influence on Indian culture through the centuries and it is astonishing that a work of literature composed two and a half millennia ago should have such resonance today. While most Indians can recite a few shlokas (verses) from the Gita and some aspire to some of its wisdom, the custom of attributing one's inspiration for ideas to the Gita seems to me to cheapen the influence, if for no other reason than the fact that most of these ideas are unlikely to match either the grandeur or the longevity of the Gita.

A] The Bhagavad Gita rises above any claim of influence connected with it even as it is primarily responsible for the ethos governing Indian managers.

B] Many Indians recite the shlokas from the Gita because they believe that it has a profound influence on the Indian culture.

C] The Bhagavad Gita is an old epic that deals with the conduct and the examination of life and still has an influence on the Indian culture. One's desire for ideas should not be attributed to the Gita because the former may not equal the greatness of the Gita.

D] The Bhagavad Gita throws light on the conduct and the examination of life but it does not in any way influence the decision making process of Indian managers.

10. Religious beliefs and practices are found in all human groups and go back to the very beginnings of human culture. Instead of searching for the origin of religion in general human urges, psychologists, anthropologists, and neuroscientists focus on the mental machinery activated in acquiring and representing religious concepts. Do people know what their religious concepts are? This may seem an absurd question, but it is in fact an important question in the psychology of religion, and whose true answer is probably in the negative. In most domains of mental activity, only a small part of what goes on in our brains is accessible to conscious inspection. For instance, we constantly

produce grammatical sentences in our native tongue with impeccable pronunciation, often without any idea how this is done. Or we perceive the world around us as made up of three dimensional objects, but we are certainly not aware of the ways in which our visual cortex transforms two retinal images into this rich impression of solid objects out there.

A] It seems strange to ask whether people know what their religious concepts are. But psychology has shown that in many mental processes, such as language and vision, we are consciously aware of only part of what actually goes on in the brain. The same applies to our understanding about religion.

B] People believe in religious concepts without necessarily knowing what they are. The reason for our perception of the world in three dimensions or the ability to speak fluently in our mothertongue is unclear because only a tiny part of the events in our brain can be inspected.

C] People should know what their religious concepts are but they do not. Similarly, they have no awareness about the mental processes in the brain responsible for the functions of complex vision and language.

D] Psychologists, anthropologists, and neuroscientists concentrate on the mental machinery activated in acquiring and representing religious values but do not focus on their origin. Just as we do not know how mental activities like vision and language functions actually take place in the brain, we do not know what our religious concepts are.

11. It can be extremely interesting to use musical influences from India in an organic way: it depends on how one thinks artistically. I play the piano, so it is natural for me to think "harmonically" a lot of the time. It is not that natural for me to think about melodies on my instrument without thinking of harmony (for jazz and classical players, the melodic aspect of the music is not separate from the harmony). Technically, I cannot bend notes on a piano so I cannot play ragas. For guitar players, it is easy to bend notes, so it is possible to have ragas as a natural part of one's thinking (based on the training). However, for an expert flamenco or blues guitar player, the thinking would be very different from a Hindustani or Carnatic guitar/ mandolin player since a different knowledge system was internalised. Even if the knowledge systems are different, musical bridges can be built by musicians who have different ways of thinking, provided they find ways to communicate with each other — the key issue is that the work of art is inspired.

A] Music influences thought processes. A different training process and the use of different instruments leads to a different approach while playing the same instrument. Musicians, therefore, need to find a common ground to communicate with each other.

B] Music can influence people in their way of thinking. Knowledge systems are inherent and cannot be learned. The same instrument can be played differently. Music builds bridges that depend on the appropriation of different music genres by musicians.

C] Music is an integral part of people's lives and in this respect it is pertinent that music can also influence actions. Though Western music is limited in its ability to adapt to Indian influences, few musicians using instruments like the guitar have made substantial progress in bridging the gap between the two systems.

D] Music is an important part of people's lives, with the ability to build bridges. Musicians are limited in the way they respond to music due to their training, which may differ from one system to another. Thus, the same system can be played differently.

12. Because we have by now so deeply internalized writing, made it so much a part of ourselves, we find it difficult to consider writing to be a technology as we commonly assume printing and the

computer to be. Yet writing (and especially alphabetic writing) is a technology, calling for the use of tools and other equipment: styli or brushes or pens, carefully prepared surfaces such as paper, animal skins, strips of wood, as well as inks or paints, and much more. Writing is, in a way, the most drastic of the three technologies. It initiated what print and computers only continue, the reduction of dynamic sound to quiescent space, the separation of the word from the living present, where alone spoken words can exist.

A] Writing is so commonplace nowadays that we don't realize that it is a technology like printing and computers, as they all require tools and specialized equipment.

B] Because we have internalized writing, we do not realize it is a technology like printing and computers, and uses its own tools. Writing is the most extreme of these, as it originated the changing of dynamic spoken sounds to static written words.

C] Writing is a technology, just like printing and computers, as it requires the use of tools and other equipment. But because we have internalized writing, we fail to realize that it is the most drastic of the three, as it started what the other two only continue.

D] Writing first turned living sound into inert space, thus initiating a drastic new technology, whose process printing and modern computers only continue, though we normally do not realize this, as we have deeply internalized writing.

13. There is a continuing tension between those who espouse growth and those who call for environment protection. When pushed, a growth protagonist will say "there must be a proper balance between environment and GDP growth". When pushed, an environmentalist will say "there must be balance between GDP growth and environment". Notice the slight shift in the sequence in the two statements. The first implies that a fetish is being made of the environment but in the final analysis a balance must indeed be struck. The second implies that a fetish is being made of economic growth but in the final analysis a balance must indeed be struck. Balance, therefore, is the key. Both sides will agree on the importance of faster economic growth and the need to factor in ecological concerns in the fast growth process. The problem lies when you go beyond "balance" as a general philosophical concept and try and give it some operational meaning. When hard choices need to be made about large projects that are considered central to economic growth, but are detrimental to the environment. Therefore every project must meet clearly defined, consistent and objective criteria, designed to safeguard the environment, before it is sanctioned.

A] The growing conflict between proponents of economic growth and environmental activists can be resolved only by taking the middle path and ensuring that large projects with environmental impacts fulfil clearly defined norms to safeguard the environment.

B] There has to be a tradeoff between economic growth and environmental protection, given the fact both economic growth and the environment are equally important to the future of the country. Both sides will never give in completely to the other's demand and hence the only way out is the middle path.

C] Owing to our increased growth aspirations as well as the growing size of the environmental community, the conflict between the latter and those pursuing faster economic growth has been increasing. The conflict between the progrowth and proenvironment camps stem from their inability to look at leaving their respective positions and exploring the possibility of chalking out a middle path that pursues economic growth but not at the expense of the environment.

D] The author argues for a more nuanced, objective and consistent approach in dealing with economic and environmental problems in the hope that it will reduce the growing divide between people in the growth camp and those in the environment camp.

14. Once confined to fantasy and science fiction, time travel is now simply an engineering problem. Physicists schooled in Newton's laws believed that time moved along a straight, steady course, like a speeding arrow. Then came Einstein in the early 1900s. His equations showed that time is more like a river. The more mass or energy you possess, the more the current around you varies. By moving at high velocity, for instance, you can make time slow down, and when you come to a stop, you'll be younger than if you'd remained at rest. Thus, a speedy spacecraft makes a fairly basic time machine.

A] Newton believed that time travel was impossible whereas Einstein advocated the possibility of designing a time machine.

B] Newton believed that time was like an arrow with a straight and steady course whereas Einstein believed that the river of time could be diverted into a whirlpool.

C] Newton believed that by moving at high velocity one could beat the pace of time, whereas Einstein propounded the mass vs the flow of time theory.

D] Newtonian laws advocated that time was like a speeding arrow with a steady course, whereas Einstein's equations showed that time was like a river that, to a body in the current, varies with changing velocity.

15. "Why should we hire you?" is a dreaded interview question that can take you down the wrong road unless you've done some thinking ahead of time. Your answer to this interview question could make or break your chances. This question is purely about selling yourself in the interview. Think of yourself as the product. Why should the customer buy? Develop a Sales Statement. The more details you give, the better your answer will be. This is not a time to talk about what you want. Rather, it is a time to summarize your accomplishments and relate what makes you unique. Take some time to think about what sets you apart from others.

A] "Why should we hire you?" is a dreadful interview question. The question is only about selling yourself forcefully and stating your uniqueness in a persuasive manner without talking about what you want.

B] "Why should we hire you?" is a question that most fear to ask. Your answer to this interview question could make or break your chances. The correct response to such a question is to introspect during the interview, reveal slowly some unique characteristics about yourself and then talk about your accomplishments in an extraordinary manner.

C] You should be prepared, cautioned or forewarned about interview questions such as the reason for which the company should hire you, and your response should highlight your strengths and weaknesses as well as your uniqueness.

D] The appropriate answer to the dreaded interview question as to why you should be hired is to be prepared for such a question and to develop a strong sales statement that would highlight your accomplishments and uniqueness.

16. I was quite prepared for Zurich to be a scenic city since it is located in Switzerland, which is nothing less than a picture book come to life. Whether it was the Swiss trains, traffic, watches or the manners, efficiency, smartness and a businesslike ambience, it was precision all around. What I didn't expect was the old world charm and the haunting recall value of the place. Zurich is all that you would expect of a modern, efficient city with its medieval air and historical attractions. These are juxtaposed so interestingly that one glides smoothly from the present into the past without feeling the jarring effects of a timewarp. There exists a city that is as vibrant and as alive as any other in the world — the cobbled streets of the Old Quarters throbbing with the live music of the

street performers, its crowds cheering lustily as a fireeater licks the flames of a torch and the juggler performs unerringly with four pairs of plates.

A] An efficient city, Zurich has an ancient atmosphere with a lot of historical or medieval attractions.

B] Zurich is a vibrant and modern city where the past and present coalesce seamlessly into one another.

C] The author was impressed with the picturesqueness of Zurich. The vibrancy of Zurich can be felt on its streets, which are vibrating with musicians and street performers.

D] Zurich is vibrant with a lot of life and can be compared to any other city in the world, contrary to its history which is interesting.

17. A young man from a small provincial town a man without independent wealth, without powerful family connections and without a university education moved to London in the late 1580's and, in a remarkably short time, became the greatest playwright not of his age alone but of all time. Shakespeare's works appeal to the learned and the unlettered, to urban sophisticates and provincial first time theatregoers. He makes his audiences laugh and cry; he turns politics into poetry; he recklessly mingles vulgar clowning and philosophical subtlety. He grasps with equal penetration the intimate lives of kings and of beggars; he seems at one moment to have studied law, at another theology, at another ancient history, while at the same time he effortlessly mimics the accents of country bumpkins and takes delight in old wives' tales. Virtually all his rivals in the highly competitive theater business found themselves on the straight road to starvation; this one playwright by contrast made enough money to buy one of the best houses in the hometown to which he retired when he was around 50, the self made protagonist of an amazing success story that has resisted explanation for 400 years.

A] Shakespeare is for everyone. His works evoke a rich tapestry of emotions. One of the prime characteristics of Shakespeare's art is the touch of the real. People rarely feel closer to understanding how the playwright's achievements came about.

B] Shakespeare's multifaceted works appeal to a variety of people and elicit a range of emotions. He was a person without much affiliations or wealth or education, yet he became wealthy unlike his rivals. He is considered the greatest play right of all times. His success story is a mystery.

C] Shakespeare's works are characteristized by extreme and apparent polarities: simple and elaborate, organic and synthetic, whimsical and profound. How Shakespeare became Shakespeare is a mystery.

D] Shakespeare is surprisingly accomplished. Very little is understood about the experiences, either then or now, that make such creative leaps possible.

18. It seems incredible, but in a country that keeps around 30% of the fresh water, and shelters the largest rain forest, in the world, we can find a "desert". Located in the State of Maranhão, on the north shore of Brazil, the Lençóis Maranhenses National Park is an area of about 300 square kilometers of blinding white dunes and deep blue lagoons, forming one of the most beautiful and unique places in the world. The dunes invade the continent over 50 km from the coast, creating a landscape that reminds a white bed sheet, when seen from above. What distinguishes this region from a desert is the amount of rain that drops over the dunes, creating ponds of crystal clear water on the depressions between dunes. It records an annual rainfall of 1,600 mm, 300 times more than in the Sahara. During drought, the lagoons evaporate and become completely dried. After the rainy season, the lagoons are home to many species of fish, turtles and clams. The mystery lies in the fact

that when the lagoons fill up, life comes back, as if they had never left the place. The eggs of the fish and crabs are probably maintained alive in the sand, exploding when rain comes back.

A] The Lençóis Maranheses is certainly a unique place you will never forget. It has 30% of the fresh water of Brazil and shelters the largest rain forest in the world. The most famous lagoon in the park, due to its beauty, is the Blue Lagoon. The lagoons are dry during drought but after the rains, they support a lot of marine life.

B] Spread over 300 sq km in Maranhão, to the north of Brazil, the Lençóis Maranhenses National Park has deep blue lagoons and blinding white dunes resembling a white bed sheet for over 50 km from the coast. Though it is a desert and the lagoons become totally dried during drought, the park records 1600 mm of annual rainfall. After the rains; fish, turtle and clams reappear in the lagoons because the eggs of fish and crabs are preserved alive.

C] The Lençóis Maranhenses National Park is one of the most beautiful and unique places in the world. It functions both as a desert and a lagoon and supports life. It gets 1600 mm of rainfall every year and covers an area of 300 square kms. The park is housed in Maranhao in Brazil.

D] Despite its desert like appearance, the Lençóis Maranhenses National Park, located in Maranhão, on the north shore of Brazil, records an annual rainfall of 1,600 mm. The lagoons of the park evaporate when there is drought but during the rains; species like fish, turtles and clams thrive. This is because the eggs of fish and crabs are, perhaps, buried alive in the sand even during the drought.

Directions for questions 19 to 40: The following question has a paragraph or two from which a sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the sentence that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

19. The writing of a novel is a form of the loss of creative liberty. In turn, the reviewing of books is a servitude still less noble. Of the writer one can at least say that he has enslaved himself – by the theme selected. The critic is in a worse position: as the convict is chained to his wheelbarrow, so the reviewer is chained to the work reviewed. _____

A] Pedantry or a joke, this methodicalness?

B] The overstatement of these simplifications is too patent to be taken seriously.

C] The writer loses his freedom in his own book, the critic in another's.

D] Here is a chance to regain creative liberty, and at the same time to wed two opposing spirits – that of the belleterist and that of the critic.

20. What exactly is a thought? It doesn't seem to weigh anything. It feels ephemeral and ineffable. You wouldn't think that a thought has a shape or smell or any sort of physical instantiation. Thoughts seem to be a kind of tremendous magic. But just like voices, thoughts are underpinned by physical stuff. We know this because alterations to the brain change the kinds of thoughts we can think. In a state of deep sleep, there are no thoughts. When the brain transitions into dream sleep, there are unbidden, bizarre thoughts. During the day we enjoy our normal, well accepted thoughts, which people enthusiastically modulate by spiking the chemical cocktails of the brain with alcohol, narcotics, cigarettes, coffee, or physical exercise_____

A] Your consciousness is like a tiny stowaway on a transatlantic steamship, taking credit for the journey without acknowledging the massive engineering underfoot.

B] The vast jungles of neurons operate their own programs.

C] The state of the physical material determines the state of the thoughts.

D] Brains are in the business of gathering information, modulating thoughts and steering behaviour appropriately.

21. Typically in the electronics industry, chips are fabricated in batches on silicon wafers. The wafers are then cut up and the individual chips packaged as components which are mounted, often by robots, onto circuit boards. The circuit boards are then installed in devices. Instead of doing things that way, a team at the Palo Alto Research Center (PARC) in California wondered about taking the individual chips as cut from the wafers and mixing them with a liquid to produce an electronic ink.

_____

Printing with "chips as ink" would provide two big benefits. The first is that the latest components from state of the art fabrication plants could be used in the ink, which means high performance devices could be printed. The second is that being a digital process driven by software, like 3D printing, an electronics printer would not rely on the economies of scale that rule most industrial processes. Just as each page of a document sent to a laser printer can be different at little or no additional cost, so too could the designs sent to an electronics printer. This is because software is easier to change than tools or production lines in a factory.

A] Printing has come a long way since Johannes Gutenberg perfected the commercial use of the printing press around 1439.

B] The ink could then be used to print electronic devices directly.

C] Making things this small allows hundreds of thousands of components to be squeezed onto a single chip.

D] All this means a single electronics printer could make lots of different things, cope with short production runs or knock out one off prototypes without incurring a cost penalty.

22. The main species of online writing might all be said to belong to the family of "commentary" rather than what is still sometimes called (though not usually without embarrassment) "literature". They have, that is, a sort of secondary status to whatever primary object they comment on; they are prompted by and dependent on some other object or event, whether a commercial product, a recent private experience, a news story, someone else's political opinion, a song or book, or whatever. This is not to disdain commentary for its failure to be primary rather than secondary, only to attempt to suggest its difference from literature._____

A] The difference between literature and commentary is a matter of perception – the interaction between them is akin to the effect of a chisel on a marble stone while making a sculpture.

B] Literature, you might say, describes a chess player's predicament over adopting a defensive strategy against an aggressive opponent, while commentary describes a mountaineer's choice of the best path to Mt. Everest from the base camp.

C] Literature, you might say, transforms the world into an illustration of the text, while commentary's relationship to the world is more like that of a caption to a photograph or a wall paragraph to a painting.

D] Literature, absorbs psychologically interesting phenomena, while commentary deals with "adult" analogues of juvenile adventure tales.

23. Five years ago Zach Sims, a sprightly, striving 21yearold, launched Code academy, a startup, to offer online courses on how to write software. He remembers pitching his idea to prospective investors only to hear a "chorus of no". At the time, the naysayers thought coding was a weird, fringe activity for computer science geeks. They were wrong. Since 2011, more than 25 million people have signed

up for Code academy. Meanwhile, in person crash courses that teach computer programming, called coding boot camps, have spread worldwide, as more people aspire to tech jobs or running their own startup. This year tuition fees at these boot camps will reach around $200m in America alone. "Be nice to nerds. Chances are you may end up working for them," wrote Charles Sykes, author of the book "50 Rules Kids Won't Learn in School", first published in 2007. Today there are more reasons than ever to treat nerds with respect. _____

A] Never mind the fact that every company is clamouring to hire them, geeks are starting to shape markets for new products and services.

B] Nerds' influence now goes well beyond technology: they hold greater cultural sway.

C] As a result, companies had better pay attention to the rise of a "nerd economy" that stretches well beyond their direct technology needs.

D] Incumbent businesses, too, have started to take their cue from all this nerdiness.

24. It is rare enough for ballet to take a true story as its subject matter, rarer still for that storyline to be overtaken by the march of science. But such is the case of "Anastasia", a ballet inspired by the curious case of Anna Anderson, a distressed young woman admitted to a Berlin mental asylum in 1920 after jumping off a bridge. Apparently unable to recall her own name, the woman was registered by the hospital as "Fräulein Unbekannt" ("Miss Unknown"). _____

A] But Anderson's story didn't end in that Berlin asylum, nor with the three act ballet made by Kenneth MacMillan, a choreographer.

B] In truth, the story of the improbable survival of Anastasia was just too good for most people not to want to believe it.

C] When another inmate claimed to recognise her as a Romanov princess, a fevered search for the woman's true identity was triggered and became a decades long cause *célèbre*.

D] The ballet centres around Anna Anderson as she sits in her iron hospital bed; curious well wishers prod and observe her; violent flashbacks torment her.

25. What do a Braille printer made out of Lego and a drone that helps farmers monitor crops have to do with chip making? Intel Capital, the venture capital (VC) unit of the American technology giant, is not quite sure yet but it wants to find out. It recently announced it was taking stakes in 16 startups, including the firms making these products. Intel has been in the venture capital business for over 20 years, and has invested in more than 1300 companies in 56 countries. _____

A] Perhaps as a result, the new generation of venture units looks better integrated with their parents: instead of chasing the next Facebook (or drone), they tend to invest in industries related to the firm's main business.

B] Over that time corporate enthusiasm for venture capital has waxed and waned – but has seldom been greater than it is now.

C] These are some indications that corporate VC is working better than in the past.

D] A bank in Silicon Valley estimated last year that corporate VC yields three times the number of patents per dollar invested than inhouse R&D.

26. It might not rank with the Battle of the Somme, but 2016 also marks the 100th anniversary of the Treaty of the Danish West Indies, which transferred sovereignty over the Caribbean islands of St John, St Thomas and St Croix from Denmark to America, for $25m (worth $550m today). The deal removed trade barriers between the Virgin Islands and their region's economic superpower, and prevented them from falling into German hands during the First World War. Now, it stands as the last time a country has directly sold control over territory to another. _____.

America's Louisiana Purchase from France in 1803 and Alaska Purchase from Russia in 1867 were big examples, and remain perfectly legal under international law. But in the postcolonial age, borders move when a state breaks up, or countries settle a dispute or, occasionally, by use of force, not because two governments simply agree to trade a chunk of land. What if that changed? With a little imagination, it is possible to see a large and varied market for such trades.

A] Even more prevalent would be militarily motivated purchases.

B] Countries whose very existence is threatened by global warming, such as Nauru, have a powerful incentive to acquire higher elevation islands from nearby states.

C] Such transactions were once common.

D] Small, rich, densely populated countries would be natural buyers from land rich, poorer states.

27. When Warren Buffett no longer "tap dances to work", as he describes it, what will become of Berkshire Hathaway, the company he created? The "Sage of Omaha" is 84 and his firm is one of America's most valuable companies, with a market capitalisation of over $350 billion. Its success has defied the conventional wisdom that conglomerates do not work. Berkshire Hathaway is a hotchpotch of 600 different businesses that deal in everything from private jets to lowcost carpets and insurance. Investors love the way the firm's share price keeps going up, but they are beginning to fret that the founder's departure will bring the good times to an end. Mr Buffett has long argued that he has built a company designed to thrive after he has gone, as he explains. Many of the people who run his businesses have also been encouraged to tell their stories to Lawrence A. Cunninham, the author of "Berkshire Beyond Buffett". _____

A] Cunninham asserts that Mr Buffett believes in giving his managers plenty of autonomy and trusting them to do the right thing, which they mostly tend to do.

B] However, the author seems too easily convinced by Mr Buffett's claims that the firm's culture will keep it on track after he has gone.

C] Indeed, Berkshire Hathaway is arguably the leading example of a company run to maximise its long term value, rather than yielding to the short termist pressures of the stockmarket.

D] The result is an unusually detailed description of Mr Buffett's management ideas and his long efforts to embed them permanently into the firm's internal systems.

28. The Kumbha Mela is an ancient version of a spiritual expo. Over the centuries, thousands of sages who have meditated, done penance and been enlightened come to the Kumbha Mela and relieve themselves of the burden of the merits gained through Sadhana by bathing in the rivers. Water has the quality to absorb the energy that they radiate. The seekers, who come from all corners to be in the company of the seers and saints, gain that merit when they take a dip in the rivers. The seers, saints and aspirants of spiritual knowledge, congregate once every twelve years specifically at the confluence, or Sangam, of the three holy rivers – Ganga, Yamuna and Saraswati. The Ganga is a symbol of knowledge and selfenquiry. It is on the banks of the Yamuna that events of love have been immortalized. _____

A] When knowledge and love come together, when the heart meets the head, Saraswati, symbolic of wisdom and fine arts, emerges.

B] There has always been a headon conflict between knowledge and love; it is finally knowledge that emerges victorious.

C] Wisdom is needed to resolve the conflict between knowledge and love.

D] But Ganga and Yamuna are incomplete without Saraswati.

29. In 1990, Voyager took a photograph of Earth that was striking precisely because it showed so little. The spacecraft was 6 billion kilometres away at the time and the image it sent back was memorably described by Carl Sagan as a "pale blue dot". Imagine, then, how pale such a dot would be if the planet in the picture were 113,000 billion kilometres away. Yet this is the distance to the nearest confirmed exoplanet – a planet orbiting a star other than the sun. _____ Only in the most special of circumstances can they actually see their quarry. Mostly, they have to work with indirect measurements, like watching for slight dips in the intensity of a star's light when a planet passes in front of it, a phenomenon known as a transit.

A] It is therefore likely to be the subject of intense future scrutiny.
B] That gives some idea of the task faced by those who study these bodies.
C] Two known exoplanets orbit their stars so closely that their rocky surfaces are evaporating.
D] But if indirect observation is all that is on offer, then astronomers must make the best of it.

30. Noughts and crosses (known as tictactoe in America) is one of the first games children learn. The more inquisitive among them soon realise there are strategies that always win if your opponent makes a mistake, and guarantee a draw even if he does not. (The best is to start out in one of the grid's corners.) _____
Using computers, quite a few games have now been solved in this formal mathematical sense. The se include Connect Four, ninemen's morris and draughts. One thing those examples have in common is that they are "perfect information" games, meaning each player knows, at all times, everything that is going on. Not all perfect information games have been so solved. Chess has not. Neither has Go. But no nontrivial "imperfect information" game, such as one involving playing cards, has ever been solved formally.

A] Such a player would not expect to lose, even over a lifetime of games against an errorfree opponent.
B] But such simplification means losing important details, and the resulting strategies are an imperfect fit to the real game.
C] When a provably ideal strategy such as this is discovered for any given game, mathematicians describe that game as being "solved".
D] The only hope is an enormous, and unlikely, conceptual breakthrough in how to attack the problem.

31. When Warren Buffett no longer "tap dances to work", as he describes it, what will become of Berkshire Hathaway, the company he created? The "Sage of Omaha" is 84 and his firm is one of America's most valuable companies, with a market capitalisation of over $350 billion. Its success has defied the conventional wisdom that conglomerates do not work. Berkshire Hathaway is a hotchpotch of 600 different businesses that deal in everything from private jets to lowcost carpets and insurance. Investors love the way the firm's share price keeps going up, but they are beginning to fret that the founder's departure will bring the good times to an end. Mr Buffett has long argued that he has built a company designed to thrive after he has gone, as he explains. Many of the people who run his businesses have also been encouraged to tell their stories to Lawrence A. Cunninham, the author of "Berkshire Beyond Buffett". _____

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B] There has always been a head on conflict between knowledge and love; it is finally knowledge that emerges victorious.
C] Wisdom is needed to resolve the conflict between knowledge and love.
D] But Ganga and Yamuna are incomplete without Saraswati.

33. When a mistake happens, some of us, instead of accepting it or trying to find out the reasons, try and justify the reasons by saying that it is not our fault or the conditions were beyond our control or that an error was bound to occur. We even justify our actions as the best way the situation could be handled. This kind of justification blocks our thinking on better ways we could have dealt with the situation or how we could be receptive to alternative ideas from others. _____
A] Some of us are prone to believing that we keep making the same mistakes because of a personality flaw.
B] Mistakes often occur due to the tendency to rush things and the need to conform to a culture that appreciates speed.
C] Hence we must avoid such justifications because every mistake provides a learning opportunity. Your answer is correct
D] Believing that our action was totally "responsible" prevents any learning from the mistake.

34. He has been dubbed a failure in school and college, but he is determined to make his life a success. He wants to become an ace salesman simply because he has the power of persuasion, negotiation and conversation. It doesn't take long before he realizes the corporate world is truly cutthroat, cruel and completely devoid of ethics._____
A] But to give it up now would be to be branded a failure twice.
B] But an ambitious horse will never return to its old stable.
C] But he knows that life is either a daring adventure or nothing.
D] Any of choices A, B or C.

35. If nature is by definition whatever is free of human manipulation, then we can never speak of a natural human environment in the same way that we speak of a natural animal environment. But what humans do is intricately linked with the environments of animals. Sometimes 'artificial' ecologies are more resilient than the ones that were displaced. Environmentalists and conservationists often deploy the word 'nature' as something that does not belong to humans, but

that humans must nevertheless actively steward and protect. This places humankind outside of nature and yet somehow instrumental in maintaining it. Climate change is clearly a threat to life on the entire planet, but the planet has been through disasters in the past. Fossil records suggest that Mother Nature does not seem to be concerned about protecting animals and plants from extinction. Whether we like it or not, the desire to preserve biodiversity and ecosystems is a very human desire. _____

A] Humans are not simultaneously outside nature and part of it because change is 'in the nature' of things.

B] Many of us have what resembles an aesthetic appreciation for (nonhuman!) life on earth in its current form.

C] I am sure many naturelovers and environmentalists would find the following sentence rather annoying: 'Beavers naturally make dams; humans naturally make plastic.'

D] Animals are incapable of changing nature and cannot find the true balance of life due to changes in nature.

36. There can be little doubt that Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels would have agreed with Lenin's nutshell definition of Marxism as "the theory and practice of the proletarian revolution." In this violently compressed formula, the key component is not the unity of theory and practice; unfortunately that has become a platitude. Nor is it "revolution"; unfortunately that has become an ambiguity. The key is the word "proletarian" the class character component. But "proletarian revolution" too, very early, took on a considerable element of ambivalence, for it could be and was applied to two different patterns. In one pattern, the proletariat carries out its own liberating revolution. _____

A] In the other, the proletariat is not interested in carrying out a revolution but is happy with status quo.

B] In the other, the revolution itself carries the proletariat to a higher level.

C] It must be emphasized that this pattern is not something peculiar to the socialist movement, but extends into socialism.

D] In the other, the proletariat is used to carry out a revolution.

37. Every work of art is the child of its age and, in many cases, the mother of our emotions. It follows that each period of culture produces an art of its own which can never be repeated. Efforts to revive the artprinciples of the past will at best produce an art that is stillborn. It is impossible for us to live and feel, as did the ancient Greeks. In the same way those who strive to follow the Greek methods in sculpture achieve only a similarity of form, the work remaining soulless for all time.

_____

A] The art of today is a hollow entity which resembles the art of bygone eras but does not evoke any emotion in the observer.

B] There is, however, in art, another kind of external similarity which is founded on a fundamental truth.

C] A work of art is the product of the emotions that are prevalent while creating the work.

D] Such imitation is mere aping.

38. Few would have the leisure to ponder about anything, leave alone "arcane" matters like consciousness, spirituality and the universe. Most of those who do would prefer to acquire their beliefs/beliefsystems, rather than arrive at them through a process of logical rigour and selfcriticism. Whether the issue is one of ethics, politics, physics or metaphysics, the beliefs

professed are usually a function of conditioned aesthetics – many people subscribe to those views that are closest to their sense of fashion, not reason. Scientism is thought or expression characteristic of scientists – an excessive belief in the power of scientific knowledge and techniques – and its proponents dismiss any idea/theory that does not square with their "scientific" worldview. _____

A] So, scientifically speaking, reality is far stranger than common sense would either let us imagine or have us believe.

B] This is contradictory, for, science and closed mindedness are, by definition, mutually exclusive.

C] Once this threshold was crossed, scientific theories would begin to flow backwards.

D] Hence scientism is different from philosophical areas like ethics and metaphysics.

39. In March 2001, futurist Ray Kurzweil had published an essay arguing that humans found it hard to comprehend their own future. It was clear from history, he had argued, that technological change is exponential – even though most of us are unable to see it – and that in a few decades, the world would be unrecognizably different. Fifteen years on, Kurzweil is a director of engineering at Google and his essay has acquired a cult following among futurists. Some of its predictions are outlandish or overhyped – but technology experts say that its basic tenets often hold. The evidence, they say, lies in the exponential advances in a suite of enabling technologies ranging from computing power to data storage, to the scale and performance of the Internet._____

A] If the pace of change is exponentially speeding up, all those advances could begin to look trivial within a few years.

B] Yet predicting the future is a fool's game; not everyone is convinced that technological change will hit humanity quite so fast.

C] "We won't experience 100 years of progress in the 21st century – it will be more like 20,000 years of progress (at today's rate)," he wrote, in '*The Law of Accelerating Returns*'.

D] These advances are creating tipping points – moments where technologies like robotics, artificial intelligence (AI), nanotechnology, 3D printing cross a threshold and trigger significant changes.

40. The Delphi method is a structured communication technique or method, originally developed as a systematic, interactive forecasting method which relies on a panel of experts. The experts answer questionnaires in two or more rounds. After each round, a facilitator or change agent provides an anonymous summary of the experts' forecasts from the previous round as well as the reasons they provided for their judgments. Thus, experts are encouraged to revise their earlier answers in light of the replies of other members of their panel. It is believed that during this process the range of the answers will decrease and the group will converge towards the "correct" answer.

_____

A] Delphi is based on the principle that forecasts (or decisions) from a structured group of individuals are more accurate than those from unstructured groups.

B] Finally, the process is stopped after a predefined stop criterion (e.g. number of rounds, achievement of consensus, stability of results) and the mean or median scores of the final rounds determine the results. Your answer is incorrect

C] The person coordinating the Delphi method is usually known as a facilitator or leader.

D] In short, participants comment on their own forecasts, the responses of others and on the progress of the panel as a whole.